

Workplace Conduct and Reporting Policy

Policy ID	HR-ER-301	Owner	Employee Relations
Effective	January 1, 2026	Next review	January 1, 2027
Status	Current	Classification	Internal
Audience	All workforce members	Company	Northstar Technologies (fictional)

Document notice: This policy is fictional and was created for retrieval-augmented generation testing. It is not legal, tax, medical, or employment advice.

1. Purpose and Scope

This policy sets expectations for respectful conduct, conflicts of interest, discrimination and harassment prevention, reporting channels, investigation cooperation, confidentiality, and non-retaliation. It applies in offices, remote work, travel, events, and digital communication.

This policy applies across company offices and approved remote locations unless a local addendum or controlling law provides a different rule. Employees should use the current policy version and ask the listed owner when facts do not fit the standard case.

2. Summary of Key Rules

Concern	Primary channel	Alternative channel
Workplace behavior	Manager or Employee Relations	Ethics hotline
Security or data incident	IT service desk or Security	Manager
Payroll or expense fraud	Finance Compliance	Ethics hotline
Immediate safety risk	Emergency services	Corporate Security

3. Expected Conduct

Workforce members must act professionally, follow lawful instructions, protect company and customer resources, and treat others respectfully. Harassment, discrimination, threats, retaliation, falsification, theft, bribery, and deliberate policy circumvention are prohibited. A disagreement or performance decision is not automatically misconduct, but it should be handled respectfully.

4. Conflicts and Gifts

Employees must disclose actual or potential conflicts, including outside work, personal relationships affecting decisions, and financial interests involving suppliers or competitors. Cash gifts are prohibited. Non-cash gifts above the locally published threshold require Compliance approval. A disclosure does not necessarily prohibit the activity; it allows appropriate safeguards.

5. Reporting and Investigation

Concerns may be raised through any channel in the table. Employees are not required to report to a person involved in the concern. Reports should include known facts and may be anonymous where permitted. Investigations are impartial and proportionate. Employees must preserve relevant information, cooperate honestly, and avoid independent evidence collection that creates risk.

6. Confidentiality and Non-Retaliation

Information is shared only with people who need it to assess or respond. Complete confidentiality cannot be guaranteed. Retaliation for reporting, participating, or refusing unlawful conduct is prohibited. Knowingly false reports may lead to action, but an unsubstantiated good-faith report is not a policy violation.

7. Exceptions, Records, and Questions

Exceptions must be lawful, documented, limited in duration, and approved by the policy owner plus any other owner named in the relevant section. Approval for one case does not change the policy for other employees. Records are retained according to the company retention schedule and any legal hold.

Related documents: Information Security and Data Handling Policy; Expense Reimbursement Policy; Performance Management Policy.

Version history

Version	Effective date	Change
1.0	January 1, 2026	Initial fictional policy issued for RAG evaluation.